Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 1803. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

Untitled continuation (E0150)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

EN G [141] E N G

Engraving, the real connoisseur and of politeness. Engraving in this country sustained a heavy loss when he died; and if the death of so excellent an artist may be considered as a public loss, it is certainly the more felt with respect to Woollett, who died while he was yet improving in that excellence (b).

Chatelaine has been termed a mannerist in his drawings, but he must certainly be allowed to be an excellent one: his etchings are variety itself. Perhaps in the department of etching no art has so happily translated the pictures of Claude de Lorraine as Francis Vivares; that is, with respect to aerial perspective, the peculiar characteristic of Claude. But his merits are not confined to this master alone; for he followed Ruydale, Berghem, Gainsborough, and Cuype, with great success. He has such a free delivery of style, that almost every one who examines his works is irretrievably impressed with an idea of performing the very same. Few artists, it has been mentioned, have excelled in the etching department. We cannot, however, omit the name of Peranezzi; who, to originality of style, which is apparently (pontaneous, joins a certain grandeur which had never been surpassed. He has transmitted to posterity foirted a representation of the Greek and Roman edifices and ruins, that travellers have often contended that they have sailed their ideas beyond the magnitude of the superstructures themselves. It is certain that in works of this fiducious nature, a degree of ruggedness in the execution corresponds with the fulminity of the subjects; and thus produces a full greater power over the mind, than if they had been more polished. Some have censured his figures, and not without cause. This defect has been ingeniously palliated by an excellent artist, Mr Bartolucci. "For (said he) if the purchasers of the works of Peranezzi get so much for their money in the building way, the figures may be supped to be given for nothing." Donatlefs those vast piles of perishing grandeur, were never more judiciously presented to the eye, than by this aflonishing artif, or better calculated to affect the mind by calling forth its most sublime ideas.

We have another striking influence of limited etching in a different portrait of the art, in the works of Ridinger, a name which brings along with it all the savage feerery of nature.

"Affembling wolves in raging troops defend. They salten on the fleed and pierce his

They fall on the field and pierce his mighty heart.

THOMSON's Winter.

For we shall ever find some peculiar beauty to admire, even in the flightest productions of genius, as well as in the most perfect productions of the burin.

There are few artists who do not regret, that etching was unknown to Bolswerf, who has done so much without its aid; from which we may easily suppose how much more he could have effected with this charming acquisition. For the truth of this remark we may appeal to his landscapes from Rubens, his animated portraits from Vandyke, and his productions from the Fle-

mith school of history, particularly his large print of the Engraving taking down from the cross from Rubens.

There is a fine influence of linear effect in a print of a Flemish conversation piece by Wille. One of the figures is drinking out of a glass, and the artist has most deceptively described the texture of the drinker's face through the glass. In the same print, a female figure shows great skill in this way, even the floor is characterized by lines; and the whole strongly marks the most proper mode of treating subjects of a mere local nature. The beautiful print of the Petit Phylicien, is also an admirable imitation, particularly the little pellucid globule which has just mounted from the hill. When lines are engraved in a square acute method of crolling, they generally convey the idea of hardness to the figure represented. The scientific Picart seems to have been so much aware of this, that in a print of his engraving of a large marble groupe of horses, from the animated chisel of Perriere, he adopted this style in order to heighten the imitation.

Mason's print of Marshal Harcourt, is one of the many fine efforts of portrait engraving; and although it was executed at an early period of the art, it abounds with no small degree of taste. The celebrated print (called the table-cloth) from Titian, of the Last Supper, also contains a considerable degree of linear differentiation, although he sometimes carries it to affectation. He is rather singular in his mode of engraving hair. Yet the portraits of Marshal Harcourt and Brilafiere the secretary may be deemed exceptions.

Wille, by the magic of his tooling, is too apt at times to give his works indiscriminately the appearance of bronze; and we frequently find the fame in the figures of Balchow: but it seems to have been referred for Strange to give the lofts of carnation to copper; and to Woollet, to give force and clearness with discriminating tale. Bartolozzi in his lines elegance delicacy and drawing; while the works of Audran teem with boldness and simplicity. In the prints of Sir Robert Strange, the greatest excellence is perhaps his rich and harmonious tones, as well as the whole effect, which is supported by an expressive fly; which he seems in a great measure to have invented for his most favourite painters, Correggio, Titian, Guido, and Guerchino. The footings, the guile, and the flowing draperies in the works of the masters, were his delight. His sleeping Cupid from Guido, and the prints of the Venus and Danse from Titian, will ever be esteemed as chef d'oeuvres in the linear art.

Having thus attempted to fulfil our original intention of discriminating the most expressive combinations of lines, and of analyzing and illustrating their various powers and effects in engraving, we shall now conclude these observations; and if, from the nature of the subject, and from the limits of the sketch, we have sailed in marking every brilliant star in the galaxy of the art, it must at least be acknowledged, that we have not omitted some of those of the first magnitude.

mitted some of those of the first magnitude. Engraving upon Glass. See Glass, Engraving on. Engraving Engraving on. ENGRAVING

(e) Although we are now contemplating linear engraving, it is but proper here to observe, that chalk engraving, mezzotinto, and aquatinta, have also made ample improvements in this country, in their various styles of excellence.

Source record

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